

SOC401

FINAL TERM PREPARATION FILE 2025

IMPORTANT SHORT AND LONG QUESTION

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THEORIES OF STRATIFICATION LESSON 21

- Theories of stratification try to explain the existing **inequality** of wealth in and between different cultures.
- Functionalists emphasize the **integrative** nature of **stratification**, which results in stability and social order.
- **Conflict** theorists assume that the natural tendency of all societies is toward change and conflict.
- **Conflict theorists** believe that stratification exists because the upper classes strive to maintain their superior position at the expense of the lower classes.
- Conflict theorists do not view stratification systems as **enviable** or desirable.
- **Conflict theory** is influenced by the wirings of **Karl Marx.**
- **Social Inequality** a state of being where certain segments of society are more well off than others .

Q)1: Functionalists

adopt a conservative position and maintain that social inequality exists because it is necessary for the functioning of society. Functionalists emphasize the integrative nature of stratification, which results in stability and social order. Functionalists argue that differential awards are necessary if societies are to recruit the best trained and most highly skilled people for highly valued positions. They maintain that highly skilled people need to be given greater rewards to act as an inventive for them to acquire the required skills. For example, a brain surgeon needs to spend enormous amounts of time and energy to develop his skills and help society and society must in turn reward him more than it does other people who do not have to make a similar investment in obtaining a skill.

Q02: Conflict Theorists

Conflict theorists assume that the natural tendency of all societies is toward change and conflict. Conflict theorists believe that stratification exists because the upper classes strive to maintain their superior position at the expense of the lower classes. Conflict theorists do not view stratification systems as enviable or desirable. Lack of social mobility leads to exploitation, crime, revitalization, reform and even to revolution. Conflict theory is influenced by the wirings of Karl Marx.

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Q)3: Functionalists versus Conflict Theorists

Integrative aspects of stratification are beneficial for society but the exploitation of under-classes does cause tensions and conflict. Neither theory can alone explain the existing use and dysfunctional aspects of stratification.

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CULTURE AND CHANGE LESSON 22

- The two principal ways that cultures change are internally through the processes of invention and innovation and externally through the process of **diffusion**.
- **Anthropologists** examine the backgrounds and psychological factors that influence innovative personalities.
- Diffusion is a **two-way** process (*reciprocity*) – both cultures change as a result of diffusion .
- **Donor** a country or even an individual entity which is at the giving end of a relationship

Q)1: How Cultures Change ?

The two principal ways that cultures change are internally through the processes of invention and innovation and externally through the process of diffusion. It is generally recognized that the majority of cultural features (things, ideas, and behavior patterns) found in any society got there by diffusion rather than invention.

Q):2 Diffusion

Diffusion is a two-way process (*reciprocity*) – both cultures change as a result of diffusion

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CULTURE AND CHANGE LESSON 23

- **Acculturation** is a specialized form of cultural diffusion that is a result of sustained contact between two cultures.
- **diffusion** involves a single or complex of traits, acculturation involves widespread cultural reorganization over a shorter period of time.
- culture are **interrelated**.
- **societies** can maintain their cultural boundaries through the exclusive use of **language**, **food**, and **clothing**.
- Cultural boundaries include relative **values**, **customs**, **language** and **eating tastes**.

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Acculturation

Acculturation is a specialized form of cultural diffusion that is a result of sustained contact between two cultures, one of which is subordinate to another.

Cultural relativity

the realization that cultural traits fit in logically within their own cultural environments and that since circumstances around the world differ, cultures are also different

Coercion

An act of force rather than that based on the need or desire of a particular individual or society

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CULTURE AND CHANGE LESSON 24

- **Globalization** is a broad-based term which is used to describe the intensification of the flow of money, goods, and information across the world, taking place since the **1980s**.
- **globalization** is responsible for an accelerated pace of change in world cultures.
- Globalization has resulted in **diffusion** of **technology** but also compounded existing inequalities.
- There are **human** and **environmental** costs associated with globalization.
- **globalization** has also increased the gap between the rich and the poor.

Globalization

Globalization is a broad-based term which is used to describe the intensification of the flow of money, goods, and information across the world, which is seen to be taking place since the 1980s. Globalization has made the study of culture change more complex due to its varied effects on various cultural processes including that of change. Intensification of the flow of money, goods, and information across the world.

Urbanization

The process of people moving from rural areas into the cities. This phenomenon is taking place in both developed and developing countries and cultural anthropologists are very interested in studying why and how urbanization takes place and the cultural changes it brings .

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POLITICAL ORGANIZATION LESSON 25

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Types of Political Systems

Societies based on bands have the least amount of political integration and role specialization (Kung in Kalahari).

Bands

Bands are most often found in foraging societies and are associated with low population densities, distribution systems based on reciprocity, and egalitarian social relations.

Tribal Organizations

With larger and more sedentary populations than are found in band societies, tribal organizations do also lack centralized political leadership and are egalitarian. Tribally based societies have certain pan-tribal mechanisms that integrate clan members to face external threats.

Clan elders do not hold formal political offices but usually manage affairs of their clans (settling disputes, representing clan in negotiation with other clans etc.).

Chiefdoms

Chiefdoms involve a more formal and permanent political structure than is found in tribal societies. Political authority in chiefdoms rests with individuals, who acts alone or with advice of a council. Most chiefdom tends to have quite distinct social ranks, rely on feasting and tribute as a major way of distributing goods. In the late nineteenth and twentieth century, many societies had chiefdoms imposed on them by colonial powers for administrative convenience (for e.g. British impositions in Nigeria, Kenya and Australia). The pre-colonial Hawaiian political system of the 18th century was a typical chiefdom.

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POLITICAL ORGANIZATION LESSON 26

- States began to be formed **5,500 years** ago with the Greek city-states and the Roman Empire providing impressive examples of state based political organization.
- Small-scale farmers in arid or semi-arid areas also **voluntarily** merged into larger political entities due to the economic advantage of **large-scale irrigation**

Political Organization Theories

Theories explaining the rise of state systems of government have centered on the question of why people surrender some of their autonomy to the power and authority of the state. There are

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theorists who argue that political organization is influenced by self interest and other theorists argue that self interest is not enough to give shape to political systems and that such organization often involves a certain amount of coercion.

Hydraulic Theory of State Formation

Small-scale farmers in arid or semi-arid areas also voluntarily merged into larger political entities due to the economic advantage of large-scale irrigation (Karl Wittfogel, 1957)

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POLITICAL ORGANIZATION LESSON 27

- **culture** has defined what are considered to be normal, proper or expected ways of behaving in society.
- **Social norms** range from etiquette to laws and imply different forms of enforcement and sanctions.
- **Positive social norms** reward people for behaving in socially expectable ways. (ranging from praise or social approval to awards or medals).
- **Negative social norms** punish people for violating the norms (ranging from disapproval to corporal punishment).
- Societies control behavior by more **formal mechanisms**.

Social Norms

All social norms are sanctioned to varying degrees according to the values held by different cultures. Positive social norms reward people for behaving in socially expectable ways (ranging from praise or social approval to awards or medals). Negative social norms punish people for violating the norms (ranging from disapproval to corporal punishment).

Social Control

Band and tribal societies (Inuit and Kung) maintain social control by means of informal mechanisms such as socialization, public opinion, lineage obligations, age organizations and sanctions. Societies control behavior by more formal mechanisms whose major function is maintaining social order and resolving conflicts.

Courts and Codified Laws

forbid individual use of force and provides legal frameworks established by legislative bodies, interpreted by judicial bodies and implemented by administrative systems like law enforcement agencies .

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PSYCHOLOGY AND CULTURE LESSON 28

- **Anthropologists** are interested in the psychological differences and similarities between societies and cultures of the world
- **Cultural Anthropologists** reject stereotypes based on hasty ethnocentric judgments .

Cognition and Culture

Recent research on psychological universals focuses on cognitive, or intellectual, development. For example, it considers how different cultures acquire thinking habits such as formal-operation notions, which enable a person to think of the possible outcomes of a hypothetical situation .In looking for universals, many researchers have discovered some apparent differences. Yet most tests used in anthropological research favors thinking patterns taught in formal schools in Western cultures.

Emotional Development

Early research in anthropology was concerned mainly with supposedly universal stages of emotional development which seems to be affected by cultural differences. *Margaret Mead* found Samoan girls were much less rebellious or emotional turmoil than those in western societies. In western societies, adolescence is a time of turmoil that helps prepare emotionally for independence.

PSYCHOLOGY AND CULTURE LESSON 29

- **Socialization** is the term that psychologists and anthropologists use to describe the development of, through the influence of parents and others, of patterns of behavior in children that conform to cultural expectations.
- **Socialization** takes place both directly and indirectly. Indirectly, the degree to which parents like children.
- **Anthropologists** not only seek to understand the link between personality traits and customs, but also how customs were themselves developed.
- **anthropologists** believe that societies produce the kind of customs best suited for undertaking activities necessary for the survival of society.
- Anthropologists are interested in understanding the possible cause of psychological differences and the possible consequences of **psychological** variation.

Socialization

Socialization is the term that psychologists and anthropologists use to describe the development of, through the influence of parents and others, of patterns of behavior in children that conform to cultural expectations.

Direct and Indirect Socialization

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Socialization takes place both directly and indirectly. Indirectly, the degree to which parents like children, the kinds of work children are asked to do and whether children go to school may at least partially influence how children develop psychologically.

IDEOLOGY AND CULTURE LESSON 30

- **ideology** is a collection of ideas. An ideology can be thought of as a comprehensive vision, as a way of looking at things.
- **Ideology** can also be seen as a set of ideas proposed by the dominant class of a society to all members of this society
- **gender ideologies** would describe what roles are expected of women and men in a society.
- **dominant ideology** appears as 'neutral', while all others that differ from the norm are often seen as radical, no matter what the actual circumstances may be.
- A **political ideology** is the body of ideals, principles, doctrine, myth or symbols of a social movement, institution, class, or large group that references some political and cultural plan.
- **Hegemony**, about which the philosopher Antonio Gramsci wrote.
- There are critics who view science as an **ideology** itself, called **scientism**.

Ideology

An ideology is a collection of ideas. An ideology can be thought of as a comprehensive vision, as a way of looking at things Ideology can also be seen as a set of ideas proposed by the dominant class of a society to all members of this society. For example, different types of gender ideologies would describe what roles are expected of women and men in a society. The ideology of economic liberalization could be seen to particularly promote the interests of the business classes.

Hegemony

When most people in a society think alike about certain matters, or even forget that there are alternatives to the current state of affairs, we arrive at the concept of Hegemony, about which the philosopher Antonio Gramsci wrote. The much smaller-scale concept of groupthink also owes something to his work. The ideologies of the dominant class of a society are proposed to all members of that society in order to make the ruling class' interests appear to be the interests of all, and thereby achieve hegemony. To reach this goal, ideology makes use of a special type of discourse: the lacunar discourse.

Epistemological ideologies

Even when the challenging of existing beliefs is encouraged, as in science, the dominant paradigm or mindset can prevent certain challenges, theories or experiments from being advanced.

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IDEOLOGY AND CULTURE LESSON 31

- **political ideology** is a set of ideas and principles that explain how the society should work, and offer the blueprint for a certain social order.
- **20th century** was communism, based on the original formulations of **Karl Marx** and **Friedrich Engels.**
- **social system,** communism is a type of egalitarian society with no state, no private property and no social classes.
- **communism** is synonymous for Marxism and its various derivatives.
- **Karl Marx** proposed a base/superstructure model of society.

- The base refers to the means of production of **society**.

- **The superstructure** is formed on top of the base, and comprises that society's ideology, as well as its legal system, political system, and religions.

- Social Darwinism, communism, laissez-faire economics, and **"free trade**".

Political ideologies

In social studies, a political ideology is a set of ideas and principles that explain how the society should work, and offer the blueprint for a certain social order. A political ideology largely concerns itself with how to allocate power and to what ends it should be used.

For example, one of the most influential and well-defined political ideologies of the 20th century was communism, based on the original formulations of Karl Marx and Friedrich Engels. Communism is a term that can refer to one of several things: a certain social system, an ideology

Economic Ideology

Karl Marx proposed a base/superstructure model of society. The base refers to the means of production of society. The superstructure is formed on top of the base, and comprises that society's ideology, as well as its legal system, political system, and religions.
Marx proposed that the base determines the superstructure. It is the ruling class that controls the society's means of production - and thus the superstructure of society, including its ideology, will be determined according to what is in the ruling class' best interests. On the other hand, critics of the Marxist approach feel that it attributes too much importance to economic factors in influencing society.

ASSOCIATIONS CULTURE and society LESSON 32

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- **Associations** are non-kin and non-territorial groups found amidst all types of societies and cultures around the world.
- Associations can **vary** from society to society.
- **Universally** ascribed qualities are found in all societies
- Gender is an example of an **ascribed** quality.
- Age set is a common form of **non-voluntary associations**, evidenced around the world, even today.
- Age sets are prominent amongst the **Nadi of Kenya** for example. Young warriors were given spears and shields in the past and told to bring back wealth to the community.
- **Karimojong** are predominantly cattle herders and number **60,000** people living in northeastern Uganda, who are organized via age and generation sets, including **5** age-sets covering **25** years.

What Are Associations?

Associations are non-kin and non-territorial groups found amidst all types of societies and cultures around the world. Associations possess some kind of formal, organizational structure and their members also have common interests and a sense of purpose which binds the varied types of societies together. Cultural anthropologists are interested in examining how different cultures give shape to different types of associations and in turn what functions different types of associations perform within particular cultures.

Non-Voluntary Associations

In relatively non-stratified societies, associatio.ns tend to be based on universally ascribed characteristics like gender and age. An age set is a common form of non-voluntary associations, evidenced around the world, even today.

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ASSOCIATIONS CULTURE and society LESSON 33

- rural migrants keep members in touch with home area traditions by the help of regional associations.
- Regional associations (*serranos*) help rural migrants adapt to urban life and Lima, Peru.
- The *serranos* have been seen to actively lobby the government on community issues, assist members with enculturation, organize fiestas, and act as clearing house for flow of information.
- Chinatowns in major cities of the world have associations performing a similar function for Chinese immigrants.
- Ethnic Associations are based on ethic ties. Such associations are particularly prominent in urban centers of West Africa.
- tribal unions are commonly found in Ghana and Nigeria which superimpose the notion of ethnicity with that of tribal ties.

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- New Guinea often link women from different tribal areas.

Regional and Ethnic Associations

Regional and ethnic organizations are voluntary associations whose members possess variably ascribed characteristics. Both forms of associations are usually found in societies where technological advance is accelerating, bringing with it numerous forms of economic and social complexities as well.

Ethnic Associations

Ethnic Associations are based on ethic ties. Such associations are particularly prominent in urban centers of West Africa. Even tribal unions are commonly found in Ghana and Nigeria which superimpose the notion of ethnicity with that of tribal ties.

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RACE ETHNICITY AND CULTURE LESSON 34

- A race is a **biological** subspecies, or variety of a species, consisting of a more or less distinct population with anatomical traits that distinguish it clearly from other races.
- We are biologically an extremely **homogenous** species.
- All humans today are **99.9%** genetically identical, and most of the variation that does occur is in the difference between males and females and our unique personal traits.
- chimpanzees have **2-3 times** more genetic variation than people. Orangutans have 8-10 times more variation.
- intense sunlight in tropical latitudes has selected for darker skin color as a protection from intense **ultraviolet radiation**.
- dark brown skin color characteristic of **sub-Saharan Africa** is also found among unrelated populations in the Indian subcontinent, Australia, New Guinea, and elsewhere in the Southwest Pacific.

Ethnicity

Ethnicity refers to selected cultural and sometimes physical characteristics used to classify people into (ethnic) groups or categories considered to be significantly different from others. Commonly recognized American ethnic groups include American Indians, Latinos, Chinese, African Americans, European Americans, etc. In some cases, ethnicity involves merely a loose group identity with little or no cultural traditions in common. This is the case with many Irish and German Americans. In contrast, some ethnic groups are coherent subcultures with a shared language and body of tradition. Newly arrived immigrant groups often fit this pattern.

Race

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A race is a biological subspecies, or variety of a species, consisting of a more or less distinct population with anatomical traits that distinguish it clearly from other races.

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RACE ETHNICITY AND CULTURE LESSON 35

- To the contrary, **"races"** are very real in the world today. In order to understand them, however, we must look into culture and social interaction rather than biological evolution.
- **Pluralism** Two or more groups living in harmony while retaining their own heritage and identity.
- **Genocide** Mass annihilation of groups of people in Nazi Germany or in Serbia for example.

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CULTURE AND BELIEFS LESSON 36

- beliefs take vary **widely** from society to society
- all cultures have **belief** systems.
- **Belief** systems fulfill social needs.
- **Belief systems** have played an important role in global social change through liberation theology (whereby believers for social reform and justice for the poor)
- **religious nationalism** (whereby religious beliefs are merged with government institutions).

Systems of Beliefs

Although all cultures have belief systems, the forms these beliefs take vary widely from society to society. It is often difficult to define belief systems cross-culturally because different societies have different ways of expressing faith

Politics and Beliefs

Belief systems have played an important role in global social change through liberation theology (whereby believers for social reform and justice for the poor) and religious nationalism (whereby religious beliefs are merged with government institutions).

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LOCAL OR INDIGINOUS KNOWLEDGE LESSON 37

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- **Local knowledge** consists of factual knowledge, skills and capabilities possessed by people belonging to a specific area.
- **Local knowledge** may on the one hand comprise fixed and structured "knowledge".
- **Local knowledge** and its respective knowledge systems are rooted in local or regional cultures, the respective social contexts and their economies.
- Originally, "**indigenous**" was equivalent to "**local**" or "**folk**" or, when applied to knowledge, "**informal knowledge**".
- **1960s** and `**70s**, the word then took on a populist flavor of grass-roots politics, in the sense of "indigenous" as opposed to state or "high" culture.
- "**indigenous knowledge**" is being used in a context of **"non-western" or "anti-western" knowledge.**

What is Local Knowledge?

Originally, "indigenous" was equivalent to "local" or "folk" or, when applied to knowledge, "informal knowledge".

In the 1960s and `70s, the word then took on a populist flavor of grass-roots politics, in the sense of "indigenous" as opposed to state or "high" culture.

Local knowledge consists of factual knowledge, skills and capabilities possessed by people belonging to a specific area. Given that local knowledge is usually geared to real-life practices, it can usually only be understood with reference to the situation in which it is to be applied.

Local knowledge is local to the extent that it is acquired and applied by people with respect to local objectives, situations and problems.

Decentralization

Decentralization should correspond with building local capacities. Therefore local knowledge on local natural and social environments (of local forest-dwellers, farmers) is often more detailed than that of formal institutions and can be used to assure sustainable development.

delegation of authority to lower levels of administration

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LOCAL OR INDIGINOUS KNOWLEDGE LESSON 38

- **local knowledge** are defined in complete contrast to scientific knowledge.
- **scientific knowledge** are neither completely different nor entirely the same; they display both commonalities and differences.
- **Local knowledge** and knowledge derived from science are similar primarily in having an empirical and a methodological basis.

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- **local knowledge** and science use observations of the outside world which are in principle accessible and communicable.
- **knowledge use experiments, local knowledge** proceeds rather from observations gained through trial-and-error or so-called **"natural experiments**", i.e. inferences drawn from the impacts of natural changes in certain quantities.

- **Scientific knowledge** on the other hand relies on controlled experiments.

- local knowledge systems seek **spatially, situation-bound or context-bound** information.

Scientific Knowledge vs. Local Knowledge

Is local knowledge ultimately equivalent to knowledge gained through science, or is it structured entirely differently? This is an age-old topic of debate in anthropology; the debate concerned with rationality and socalled *alternative modes of thought.*

A corresponding practical question is if local knowledge can be utilized within the framework of scientifically-based measures? Or, is local knowledge a holistic counter-model to science (to be used to criticize measures founded on analytical science)?

Most characterizations of local knowledge are defined in complete contrast to scientific knowledge. But local and scientific knowledge are neither completely different nor entirely the same; they display both commonalities and differences.

Similarities between Local & Scientific Knowledge

Local knowledge and knowledge derived from science are similar primarily in having an empirical and a methodological basis. Both local knowledge and science use observations of the outside world which are in principle accessible and communicable.

While both forms of knowledge use experiments, local knowledge proceeds rather from observations gained through trial-and-error or so-called "natural experiments", i.e. inferences drawn from the impacts of natural changes in certain quantities. Scientific knowledge on the other hand relies on controlled experiments.

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ANTHROPOLOGY AND DEVELOPMENT LESSON 39

- **development** is a transition towards directed change, towards modernization, industrialization and capitalization.
- **Anthropological** studies focus on the processes of social transformation, positive and negative, conventionally associated with development.
- anthropological methods, development is people focused and uses **qualitative** techniques.

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- Development Organizations include multilateral agencies like the **World Bank and UN agencies, bilateral agencies, national and international NGOs.**

What is Development?

In the popular meaning of the term, development is a transition towards directed change, towards modernization, industrialization and capitalization. However, major development agencies and multilateral organizations often interpret development in terms of poverty.

Poverty, defined in relation to the absence of basic services and in income terms (less than one dollar a day), becomes a proxy for the absence of development, and a justification for intervention. Poverty and development are measured by indicators and targets, some global, others national, which become standard devices for undertaking development.

Social Development

The effort to meet basic needs and to assure access to basic human right .

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ANTHROPOLOGY AND DEVELOPMENT LESSON 40

- **comparative knowledge** of social organization: gender, kinship, property resources.
- **Anthropological input** is often restricted to appraisal and analysis of planned outcome failures.
- **international development**, use of applied anthropology has grown in the West as well.
- Anthropology in the **US** and in South America is often associated with cultural brokerage between indigenous groups and national governments.
- Research on development and culture during the past years has emphasized a culture-sensitive approach in **development**.
- the **World Bank** has recognized the complex local environments in which development policy was supposed to operate and had failed was due to lack of participation.
- A modified policy discourse spoke the need to include local people, **civil society**, and social networks in planning and implementation.
- Induction of anthropologists in development agencies in the **1980's and 1990's** coincided with a new people oriented discourse in international development and a renewed focus on social exclusion and marginality.

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ANTHROPOLOGY AND DEVELOPMENT LESSON 41

- **Anthropologists** are expected to address social rather that technical aspects of development programs.

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- **Anthropologists** can help in this regard given their understanding of cultural similarities and differences.
- Hierarchies are found **everywhere**.

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CULTURAL ANTHROPOLOGY AND ART LESSON 42

What is Art?

Art can be defined as the process and products of applying certain skills to any activity that transforms matter, sound, or motion into a form that is deemed aesthetically meaningful to people in a society. Yet there is no universal definition of art. Art reflects the human urge to express oneself and to take pleasure from aesthetics. The creative process of art is enjoyable, produces an emotional response and conveys a message.

Art and Anthropology

Art plays a useful social function and is prominent in ceremonies and customs of most cultures. The forms of artistic expression of relevance to cultural anthropologists include graphic and plastic arts (such as painting, carving, and weaving), music, dance, and verbal art (such as myth and folklore).

Art and Politics

It is possible to see symbols of political power expressed via art. In Polynesia, leadership based on centralized chiefdoms results in chiefs using permanent tattoos to reflect their hereditary high status. In Melanesia, on the other hand, power is more fluid and the 'big men' indicate their authority using temporary body paints.

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CULTURAL ANTHROPOLOGY AND ART LESSON 43

Functionalist Perspectives Concerning Art

Manilowski tended to emphasize how various cultural elements function for the psychological well-being of the individual. Radcliff-Brown stressed how a cultural functional element of art functions to contribute to the well-being or continuity of society.

Psychological Benefits of Art

For the artist, artistic impressions enable expression of emotional energy in a concrete and visible manner. The creative tension released via artistic expression brings personal

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gratification. Works of art evoke emotional responses from their viewers, which can be positive or negative, but do help relieve stress.

Art and Social Integration

Art functions to sustain longevity of the society in which it is found. Art is connected to other parts of the social system and used to evoke positive feelings for its rulers. Even in ancient Aztec and Egyptian civilizations the ziggurats and pyramids served to provide a visual reinforcement of the awesome power of the rulers. Art forms like music also help reinforce social bonds and cultural themes. Martial music, on the other hand, helps rally people against a common enemy. Story-telling also passes on social values from one generation onto the next, whereby helping social integration.

Art and Social Control

A popular perception concerning artists is that they are non-conformist, visionary and aloof. Art often reinforces existing socio-cultural systems. It also instills important cultural values and influences people to behave in socially appropriate ways. Art can buttress inequalities of existing stratification systems. In highly stratified societies, state governments use art for maintaining the status quo and to solicit obedience and respect.

Art as a Status Symbol

Acquiring art objects provides a convincing way to display one's wealth and power. Possessing art objects implies high prestige due to its uniqueness. Art in ancient Egypt was the personal property of the pharos. Art galleries often exhibit personal collections obtained from high ranking members of society.

Art as a Form of Protest

Art functions as a vehicle for protest, resistance and even revolution. Various artists have attempted to raise the consciousness of their countrymen through their poems, painting and plays and helped instigate sociopolitical changes.

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ETHICS AND ANTHROPOLOGY 44

Ethical Condemnation

Since the 1960s, cultural anthropology has been the target of critical attacks both from within and without the discipline. The condemnation of anthropology and anthropologists by postmodernism, literary theory, and post-colonialism, among others, has been directed at its status as a science and its participation in the oppression of minorities and justification of colonialism.

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RELEVANCE OF CULTURAL ANTHROPOLOGY 45

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Contemporary Anthropologists

Anthropological research has great relevance for the public at large. Consider for example the role archaeology played in society during the nineteenth century. Books on the subject were widely read. Darwin's work, for example, significantly changed beliefs on human history and development of the modern world. Throughout this era of advancements academic archaeology was on the rise. This movement finally phased out the participation of amateurs in the field, creating a more elitist and inaccessible discipline. While professionalization has certainly had numerous benefits - including developments in "method, theory and culture historical knowledge", its negative aspects are causing a significant deterioration of popular interest in archaeology.

Holistic ethnographies

overarching description concerning all aspects of life of a given community

SOC401 CURRENTLY PAPER

Q. Local and scientific knowledge are neither completely different nor entirely the same; they display both commonalities and differences. Discuss in detail.

Local Knowledge	Scientific Knowledge
It refers to the understanding and skills developed by people in a specific area through experiences and traditions.	It is based on systematic study, experiments, and evidence.

Both have value and can overlap, but they are developed in different ways. Local knowledge is practical and rooted in culture, while scientific knowledge relies on testing and evidence.

Q. Culture and Change

- **Culture** is the way of life, including customs, beliefs, and arts, of a particular group of people.
- **Change** in culture happens when new ideas, technologies, or interactions with other cultures alter these ways of life. Cultures evolve over time due to various influences like globalization, innovation, and social movements.

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Q. Political Organization

This refers to how a society creates and maintains a system of rules and leadership. It includes everything from governments and laws to informal leadership and community decision-making processes.

Q. Psychology and Culture

This field studies how culture influences mental processes and behaviors. It looks at how cultural backgrounds affect things like emotions, motivations, and personality development.

Q. Ideology and Culture

Ideology is a set of ideas and beliefs about how the world should be.

Culture is broader and includes all aspects of a way of life. Ideologies can shape cultural norms and values, while culture can influence which ideologies become popular.

Q. Patrilocal residence is common in patrilineal cultures. Enlist any three most common types of residence patterns evidenced around the world.

- Patrilocal: the couple can live with or near the relatives of the husband's father (most prevalent)
- Matrilocal: the couple can live with or near the relatives of the wife's father
- Avunculocal: the couple can live with or near the husband's mother's brother
- Ambilocal or bilocal: the couple can live with or near the relatives of either the wife or the husband
- Neolocal: Where economic circumstances permit, the couple can also establish a completely new residence of their own.

Q. Associations, Cultures and Societies.

- **Associations** are organized groups with a common purpose, like clubs or professional organizations.
- **Cultures** are the shared practices, beliefs, and values of a group.
- **Societies** are larger groups of people living together in an organized way, sharing laws, institutions, and traditions.

Q. Race, Ethnicity and Culture

- **Race** is a social construct based on physical characteristics like skin color.
- **Ethnicity** refers to shared cultural practices, language, and heritage.
- **Culture** encompasses the broader way of life, including traditions, beliefs, and norms.

All three are related but distinct concepts.

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Q. Culture and Beliefs

Beliefs are ideas accepted as true by a group of people, forming a part of their culture. Culture shapes and is shaped by these beliefs, influencing everything from daily behavior to long-term goals.

Q. Local or Indigenous Knowledge

This is the wisdom and practices developed by indigenous or local communities over time, often passed down through generations. It includes ways of farming, healing, and interacting with the environment that are specific to a particular area.

Q. Anthropology and Development

This field examines how societies change and develop, often focusing on economic and social progress. Anthropologists study the impacts of development projects on cultures and communities, aiming to ensure that development is sustainable and culturally sensitive.

Q. Cultural Anthropology and Art

Cultural anthropology studies human societies and cultures, including their art forms. It looks at how art reflects and influences cultural values, social structures, and historical contexts.

Q. Ethics in Anthropology

Ethics in anthropology involves respecting the dignity, privacy, and rights of people being studied. Anthropologists must conduct research honestly and responsibly, avoiding harm to individuals and communities.

Q. Relevance of Cultural Anthropology

Cultural anthropology helps us understand the diversity of human experiences and fosters empathy for different ways of life. It provides insights into how cultures shape behaviors and social structures, informing everything from policy to personal interactions.

Q. Anthropologists believe that culture affects individual's personalities. Explain this with reference to the David Riesman's theory of three common types of personalities.

- Tradition-directed - Guided by established customs and traditions.
- Inner-directed - Guided by internal principles and values, often set in childhood.
- Other-directed - Guided by the expectations and behaviors of peers and society.

Q. Define development

Development refers to the process of improving the quality of life and economic well-being of people. This can include increasing access to education, healthcare, and employment opportunities, as well as enhancing infrastructure and promoting sustainable practices. Development aims to reduce poverty, inequality, and unemployment, fostering overall societal progress and individual prosperity.

Q. Role of development anthropologists in the field of study

Development anthropologists study the cultural, social, and economic impacts of development projects on communities. They work to ensure that development initiatives are culturally appropriate, sustainable, and beneficial for local populations. By understanding the local context

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and collaborating with communities, development anthropologists help design and implement projects that respect and integrate local knowledge and practices, thus enhancing the effectiveness and acceptance of these initiatives.

Q. Difference between Ethnic and Multi-ethnic association

Ethnic association	Multi-ethnic association
It is an organized group formed by people who share a common ethnic background, focusing on promoting their cultural heritage and addressing specific needs of their ethnic community.	It includes members from multiple ethnic backgrounds, aiming to foster inclusivity, diversity, and cooperation among different ethnic groups within a broader community or organization.

Q. Gender ideology

Gender ideology refers to the set of beliefs and norms about the roles, behaviors, and expectations of individuals based on their gender. These ideologies shape how societies view masculinity and femininity, influence personal identities, and affect the distribution of power and resources. Gender ideologies can be traditional, reinforcing stereotypical gender roles, or progressive, advocating for gender equality and challenging established norms.

Q. types of societies

- Stratified societies, which are associated with the rise of civilization, range from open class societies, which permit high social mobility, to more rigid caste societies, which allow for little or no social mobility
- Class societies are associated with achieved status, the positions that the individual can choose or at least have some control over.
- Caste societies, on the other hand, are based on ascribed statuses into which one is born and cannot change.

Q. two types of personalities according to David Riesman

Inner-directed personalities are guided by internal values and principles instilled during childhood, often from family and cultural traditions.

Other-directed personalities, on the other hand, are shaped by the expectations and behaviors of peers and the broader society, adapting to changing social norms and trends.

Q. Define stratified society

A stratified society is one where individuals are divided into hierarchical layers based on factors such as wealth, power, occupation, education, and social status. In such societies, there is a clear distinction between different social classes, with unequal access to resources and opportunities. This stratification influences people's lifestyles, life chances, and interactions within the community.

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Q. define class society

A class society is characterized by the division of the population into different social classes based on economic factors, primarily income and wealth. These classes include the upper class, middle class, and lower class, each with distinct levels of access to resources, power, and opportunities. Class societies often have significant social mobility, but the extent of mobility can vary widely.

Q. functionalist verses conflict theory

functionalist theory	conflict theory
It views society as a complex system where each part works together to promote stability and harmony. It emphasizes the importance of social	It focuses on the power struggles and conflicts between different social groups. It argues that social structures and institutions often serve the interests
institutions and their roles maintaining in societal equilibrium.	of the dominant groups, leading to inequality and social change driven by these tensions.

Q. define globalization

Globalization is the process by which countries and cultures become more interconnected and interdependent through increased economic, political, and cultural exchange. This phenomenon is driven by advancements in communication, transportation, and technology, leading to the spread of ideas, goods, services, and people across international borders, and fostering a more integrated global economy and culture.

Q. define bands, tribal, chiefdoms

- **Bands** are small, kin-based groups of foragers who are typically egalitarian and have no formal leadership.
- **Tribes** are larger than bands and often engage in horticulture or pastoralism, with leadership roles that are usually informal and based on kinship or age.
- **Chiefdoms** have more formalized and hierarchical leadership structures, with chiefs who hold significant authority and control over resources, often supported by a bureaucracy.

Q. Hydraulic Theory versus coercive theory

Hydraulic Theory	coercive theory
It suggests that the development of complex societies, especially in arid regions, was driven by the need to manage and control water resources for agriculture. This led to centralized authority and organized governance	It argues that state formation results from the use of force and warfare, where dominant groups subjugate others to establish control and create centralized political structures.

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Q. Some societies maintain their cultural boundaries through the exclusive use of language, food and clothing. Some societies resist change in their culture. Discuss.

Some societies use specific languages, traditional foods, and distinctive clothing to preserve and express their cultural identity, creating a sense of belonging and continuity. These cultural markers help maintain boundaries and resist external influences. Other societies actively resist change to protect their cultural heritage from erosion by globalization or modernization. This resistance can be seen in efforts to preserve indigenous languages, uphold traditional practices, and reject foreign cultural elements, aiming to maintain a unique cultural identity and cohesion.

Q. Define caste society

A caste society is a hierarchical social structure where individuals' social status is determined by birth and is usually fixed for life. In such societies, there are strict rules about social interaction and marriage between different castes, and individuals have limited social mobility. The caste system often dictates aspects of daily life, including occupation, dietary habits, and religious practices, reinforcing inequality and social stratification.

Q. define conflict theorist

A conflict theorist examines society through the lens of power dynamics and inequalities, focusing on the struggles between different social groups. They believe that societal structures and institutions often perpetuate the dominance of powerful groups over others, leading to continuous conflict and social change. Conflict theorists analyze how resources, power, and opportunities are distributed unequally, and they advocate for addressing these disparities to achieve social justice.

Q. define diffusion

Diffusion is the process by which cultural elements, such as ideas, customs, technologies, and practices, spread from one society or cultural group to another. This can happen through various means, including trade, migration, warfare, or communication. As cultures interact, they exchange and adopt new elements, leading to cultural blending and innovation.

Q. define urbanization

Urbanization refers to the process by which rural areas transform into urban areas, resulting in the growth of cities and towns. This involves a shift in population from rural to urban settings, often driven by factors such as industrialization, economic opportunities, and better access to services and amenities. Urbanization can lead to significant social, economic, and environmental changes.

Q. define Voluntaristic State Formation

Some theorists suggest that those engaging in specialized labor voluntarily gave up their autonomy in exchange for perceived benefits. Political integration can mediate between and protect interests of varied groups and provide them an economic superstructure required for specialization (Chide, 1936).

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Q. define ideology

Ideology is a system of ideas, beliefs, and values that shapes the way individuals perceive and interact with the world. It provides a framework for understanding social, political, and economic realities, guiding behavior and influencing public policies and societal norms. Ideologies can be religious, political, or cultural, and they often serve to justify the status quo or advocate for change.

Q. specimen of Mughal's architecture present the tremendous power of Mughal rulers. How architecture and other forms of art contribute to the longevity of society?

Mughal architecture, exemplified by monuments like the Taj Mahal and Red Fort, reflects the grandeur and authority of the Mughal Empire, showcasing their artistic and engineering prowess. Architecture and other forms of art contribute to the longevity of society by preserving cultural heritage, fostering national pride, and providing tangible links to the past. They inspire future generations, attract tourism, and serve as symbols of cultural identity and continuity.

Q. what is local knowledge?

Local knowledge refers to the understanding, skills, and practices developed by people in a specific area through long-term observation, experience, and interaction with their environment. This knowledge is often passed down through generations and encompasses various aspects of life, such as agriculture, medicine, and natural resource management. It is deeply rooted in the cultural and ecological context of the community.

Q. what is development?

Development is the process of improving the economic, social, and environmental conditions of a society. It involves enhancing the quality of life, increasing access to resources and opportunities, and promoting sustainable growth. Development aims to reduce poverty, inequality, and unemployment while fostering education, healthcare, infrastructure, and overall well-being.

Q. what is art? Example of art

Art is a diverse range of human activities and creations that express imagination, creativity, and technical skill. It encompasses various forms, including visual arts (painting, sculpture), performing arts (theater, music, dance), and literary arts (poetry, literature). An example of art is Leonardo da Vinci's painting "Mona Lisa," renowned for its artistic mastery and enigmatic expression.

Q. differentiate between communism and capitalism

Communism is an economic and political system where all property and resources are collectively owned and controlled by the state or community, aiming for equal distribution of wealth and the elimination of class distinctions. **Capitalism**, on the other hand, is an economic system based on private ownership of property and businesses, where individuals and companies operate for profit in a competitive market. The key difference lies in the ownership and distribution of resources: collective in communism, and private in capitalism.

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Q. Every society has an ideology that forms the basis of the public opinion or common sense. Being a student of cultural anthropology how will you describe the notion of ideology?

In cultural anthropology, ideology is understood as the set of shared beliefs, values, and ideas that shape the worldview and behavior of a society's members. It forms the foundation of public opinion and common sense, influencing how people interpret their social reality and make decisions. Ideologies are deeply embedded in cultural practices and institutions, often serving to legitimize existing power structures and social norms.

Q. in recent year how social change

In recent years, social change has been driven by technological advancements, globalization, and social movements. The proliferation of the internet and social media has accelerated communication and information sharing, fostering global awareness and activism. Social movements advocating for gender equality, environmental sustainability, and human rights have gained momentum, challenging traditional norms and promoting progressive policies. Economic shifts and demographic changes have also contributed to evolving social structures and cultural dynamics.

Q. define direct and indirect socialization

Direct socialization involves explicit teaching and instruction from parents, teachers, and other authority figures, where specific behaviors, norms, and values are deliberately conveyed to individuals. Indirect socialization occurs through observation and imitation, where individuals learn by watching others and absorbing cultural norms and behaviors from their surroundings without explicit instruction.

Q. political versus economic ideologies

Political ideologies encompass beliefs and values about the organization and governance of society, including ideas about democracy, authority, and the role of the state. Economic ideologies, on the other hand, focus on how resources should be produced, distributed, and consumed, including beliefs about capitalism, socialism, and economic equality. While political ideologies address power and governance, economic ideologies concern wealth and resource management.

Q. define race

Race is a social construct used to categorize and differentiate people based on physical characteristics such as skin color, facial features, and hair texture. While race has no biological basis, it has significant social implications, affecting people's experiences, opportunities, and interactions within society. Racial categories are often used to justify unequal treatment and discrimination, leading to systemic inequalities.

Q. what is scientific knowledge?

Scientific knowledge is the understanding of the natural and social world based on empirical evidence, observation, experimentation, and systematic study. It is characterized by the use of the scientific method, involving hypothesis testing, data collection, and analysis to develop

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theories and laws that explain phenomena. Scientific knowledge is continually refined and validated through peer review and replication.

Q. who undertakes development?

Development Organizations include multilateral agencies like the World Bank and UN agencies, bilateral agencies, national and international NGOs. Typical partner organizations include national governments, national NGOs and the lower tier community based organizations.

Q. define orientalism

Orientalism is a term coined by Edward Said to describe the Western portrayal and interpretation of Eastern cultures, often characterized by stereotypes and a sense of superiority. It involves the depiction of Eastern societies as exotic, backward, and uncivilized, which serves to justify colonialism and domination. Orientalism reflects a power imbalance, where the West constructs and controls the narrative about the East.

Q. how association form?

Associations form when individuals with common interests, goals, or needs come together to organize and collaborate. This can happen informally through social networks or formally through structured organizations with defined memberships, rules, and objectives. Associations can be created for a variety of purposes, including professional development, social advocacy, cultural preservation, and recreational activities.

Q. It is important not to confuse the term minority with ethnic group. Ethnic groups may be either a minority or a majority in a population. Support this statement by narrating an example from past related society?

The distinction between minority and ethnic group is crucial, as ethnic groups are defined by shared cultural traits, while minority status refers to numerical representation. For example, in South Africa during apartheid, the white population, although a numerical minority, held the majority of political and economic power, while the black population, the numerical majority, was marginalized and oppressed. This shows that ethnic groups can either be a minority or majority, depending on the context and power dynamics within a society.

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